

Freshman Alumni Bot

A guide for group leaders · @freshmanalumni_bot

How to set it up

Three steps, about a minute. Nothing to send us, no settings to change on our side.

- 1** Open the group you want the bot working in, and add it as a member: **Members** → **Add member** → @freshmanalumni_bot
- 2** Promote it to **Administrator**, and turn on the **Pin messages** right.
- 3** Send **/gate_announce** in the group. The bot posts the join announcement and pins it. That's your confirmation the setup worked.

Repeat in every group you want covered. Each one is handled independently and gets its own announcement, so you choose which groups take part and you can add more whenever you like.

Reference

Read once, or only when something looks wrong.

Why Administrator matters

Admin rights are not a formality — the bot is inert without them. Telegram only tells a bot who joins a group if it is an administrator, and pinning needs the **Pin messages** right specifically. If you add the bot as an ordinary member, nothing happens at all: no enrolment, no announcement, no error. **That is the single most common reason a group looks broken.**

Promoting the bot is also what enrolls the group — there is no separate opt-in, and nobody has to add your group to a list. Step 3 only controls *when* the announcement appears: skip it and the bot posts one by itself within the hour, then re-posts every five days.

What the bot puts in your group

Exactly two things ever appear in the group chat:

- 1 **The pinned announcement** — two buttons, *Join the Alumni group* and *I'm already in it*. It re-posts itself every five days and deletes the previous one, so only one is ever live.
- 2 **A follow-up message** naming the people who still haven't tapped either button, sent a few days after the announcement.

Everything else is a private DM. Nobody is tagged in the group for not having joined, and nobody is corrected in front of everyone. You can tell your members that safely.

What a member goes through

So you can answer “what is this bot?” without asking us: they tap **Join the Alumni group**, which opens the bot in a private chat. There it asks them to fill in a short form, read the values doc, and send a 50–100 word intro. Once all three are done it hands them a personal one-time invite link and they're admitted automatically. Tapping **I'm already in it** is checked against the real group, so it can't be used to skip the process.

If something looks wrong

/gate_announce does nothing	Nine times out of ten the bot is a member but not an Administrator — it can't post or read the group without that. Fix the rights and run it again. If it still does nothing, tell us: the gate may not be switched on yet.
It isn't pinned	The bot has admin rights but not Pin messages . The announcement still works unpinned.
Nobody ran /gate_announce	No harm done — the bot re-posts the announcement on its own every few days, so a group set up and forgotten still gets one.
“But I am in the group!”	Almost always a second Telegram account. Ask which account they use in the alumni group, and have them open the bot from that one.
“The bot won't reply to me”	They need to tap Start in the private chat once. Telegram won't let a bot message anyone who hasn't.
Anything else	Message @gapyearingdoesntsuck.

/gate_announce works for anyone who is an admin of the group they run it in — no list to be added to. The core team additionally has **/gate_stats**, **/gate_groups**, **/gate_list** and **/gate_unwatch**; those check an internal admin list and stay silent for everyone else, so if one does nothing, ask @gapyearingdoesntsuck rather than retrying.